

Reading Comprehension

Agriculture Sector in India

(1) Agriculture has always been an important part of India's economy and society. A large number of people depend directly or indirectly on farming for their livelihood. India grows a wide variety of crops because of its different climates, soils and geographical conditions. Rice, wheat, pulses, sugarcane, cotton, tea and spices are among the important agricultural products of the country.

(2) Indian agriculture has changed considerably over the years. The use of improved seeds, irrigation facilities, modern machinery and better farming methods has helped farmers increase crop production. Technology has also made it easier to obtain information about weather, soil conditions and market prices. These developments can help farmers make better decisions and reduce the risks involved in farming.

(3) However, farmers in India continue to face several challenges. Uncertain rainfall, water shortages, rising input costs and changing weather conditions can affect crop production. Small and marginal farmers may find it difficult to afford modern equipment and expensive inputs. In some areas, farmers also face difficulties in storing and transporting their produce, which can reduce their earnings.

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Agriculture Sector in India — Passage Continued

(4) Sustainable farming can play an important role in addressing some of these challenges. Methods such as rainwater harvesting, crop rotation, efficient irrigation and the careful use of fertilisers can help conserve natural resources. Farmers can also benefit from growing different crops and using practices that maintain soil fertility. Such methods can support agricultural production while protecting the environment.

(5) The future of Indian agriculture depends on combining traditional knowledge with modern technology. Better irrigation, improved storage facilities, access to markets and timely information can help farmers improve their incomes. At the same time, protecting soil, water and other natural resources is essential. With suitable support and responsible farming practices, agriculture can continue to contribute significantly to India's development.

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Questions

Answer the following questions based on the passage above:

Question 1: Why is agriculture important in India?

- (A) It provides livelihood to many people
- (B) It is India's only industry
- (C) It is used only for exports
- (D) It requires no technology

Question 2: Mention **any two** modern developments that have helped Indian farmers.

Question 3: How can technology help farmers?

- (A) By providing information about weather and market prices
- (B) By stopping rainfall
- (C) By eliminating all farming risks
- (D) By replacing all farmers

Question 4: Complete the sentence:

Uncertain rainfall, water shortages and rising input costs are some of the _____ faced by Indian farmers.

Question 5: What difficulties may small and marginal farmers face?

Question 6: Which of the following is an example of sustainable farming?

- (A) Wasting water
- (B) Excessive use of fertilisers
- (C) Crop rotation
- (D) Removing all trees near farms

Question 7: What does “**conserve natural resources**” mean in paragraph (4)?

- (A) Use them carefully and avoid unnecessary wastage
- (B) Use them as quickly as possible
- (C) Stop farming completely
- (D) Increase the use of chemicals

Question 8: According to the passage, how can Indian agriculture become more successful in the future?